

Creating the Infrastructure for Ethical AI use at Savannah College of Art and Design

Dan Bartlett

Dean of the School of Animation and Motion, Savannah College of Art and Design, USA
dbartlett@scad.edu

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1 INTRODUCTION

The advent of Artificial Intelligence, seen most commonly through the emergence of complex Neural Networks, Large Language Models and Generative Art programs built on huge datasets, is set to have a profound and permanent impact on the design and execution of arts pedagogy. The application of AI systems in advancing, and in some instances replacing, entire computer graphics workflows is quickly gathering pace, with many studios already taking steps to either develop proprietary systems or develop partnerships with fledgling AI developers. This evolution of computer graphics workflows is likely to directly impact the efficacy and validity of higher education arts curriculum, and as such it is imperative that Higher Education Institutions take meaningful steps to advance their pedagogy in line with this evolution.

In response to this challenge, in 2023 Savannah College of Art and Design instituted a robust institute-wide series of initiatives with a common goal – Identify and action the steps needed to prepare for the impact of AI technologies upon arts education. In this talk/panel discussion we will explore the strategies deployed by Savannah College of Art and Design, how the institution took steps to first identify the potential impact on arts education, and what resources and guiding principles were used in response to the advent of AI technologies. We will review and contextualize each key phase of the project, including the processes by which SCAD engaged with external partners and the student body to understand existing knowledge, current use cases, and the broader landscape of AI technologies as they relate to arts practice.

2 THE 2024 AI SUMMIT

The first section of the talk will showcase the structure and outcomes of the inaugural SCAD AI Summit, during which external

thought leaders from sectors such as Visual Effects, Games Design, User Experience, and Computer Graphics met with academic leaders from SCAD develop the roadmap and foundational principles for the university's adoption of AI tools and systems. This will include a breakdown of how this summit was designed, how its strategic objectives were defined and how the active input and collaborative efforts of these external partners was instrumental in defining a series of tangible actions that would form later milestones within the broader initiative. This section of the talk will reflect not only on the findings of the AI Summit activities, but also on the larger implications of direct collaboration and knowledge exchange with external partners. Multi-stakeholder collaboration as a process to engineer an adoption strategy, and arguably more importantly an ethical practice framework that would go on to inform the construction of an AI pedagogy that is targeted specifically toward arts education.

We will explore and discuss how SCAD students were treated not just as a stakeholder in the development SCAD's AI roadmap, but also as an active collaborator and participant throughout. In the Fall quarter of 2023, SCAD brought together twenty students from across a wide spectrum of the student population at SCAD. In this section of the talk, we will explore the findings produced by this class, and discuss how this group of students were able to not only collate and contextualize the behaviours and sentiment of their peers, but also produce a robust series of recommendations for how SCAD could potentially utilize AI tools across its academic, technical and business operations. We will also explore how within the scaffolding of this class the students also curated a series of "best practice" examples from across the university and created a showcase of prominent, effective uses of AI within majors such as Visual Effects, Advertising and Branding, and Interactive Design and Game Development. majors to participate in "LAB560: AI is an Ocean"- a user research class that explored the affinity, understanding and uses of AI specifically within

3 THE AI ADVANTAGE PORTAL

Finally, this talk will present and analyze the third phase of actions undertaken by Savannah College of Art and Design, specifically the launch of series of training resources and collaboration opportunities designed to embed an ambitious, inquisitive and ethical use of AI technologies across SCAD's academic, creative and community operations. Under the banner of the "SCAD AI Advantage Portal" this suite of tools, resources and training opportunities intends to equip students, faculty and staff with the skills and materials they need to continue to elevate their respective creative practices and leverage AI tools and workflows to facilitate this. We will review how use of these resources is specifically impacting the work within majors such as Visual Effects, Animation, Games Design and

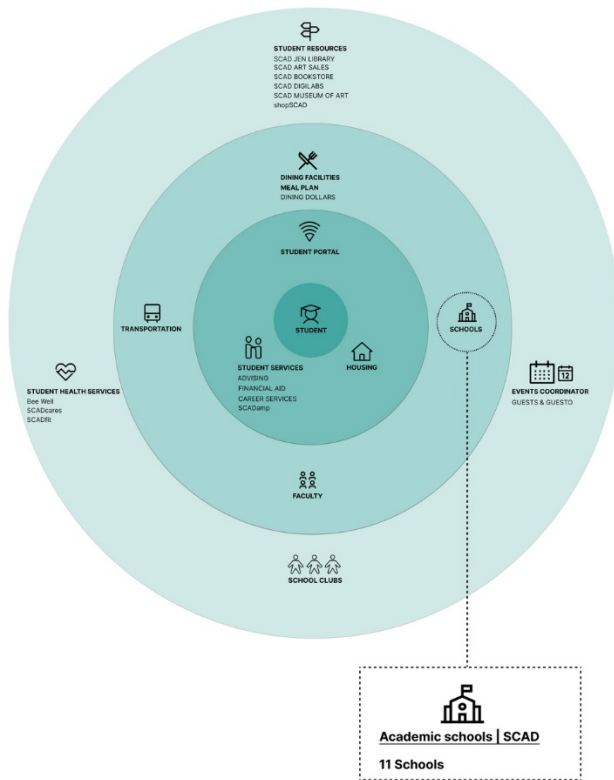
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Immersive Reality at SCAD. This talk will provide valuable insights to peers in other academic institutions, and as a case study will demonstrate how effective collaboration with stakeholders, both internal and external, can yield tangible and lasting results that amplify and accelerate arts education

Figure 1: SCAD Savannah Stakeholder Map. LAB560. 2023, Savannah College of Art and Design